

Tone of Voice Document



0.0

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1.1

Tone of voice

Definition

Tone of voice (TOV) is not so much what you say, but how you say it.

This determines how a brand's character comes across in written and spoken words, and the impression this makes on the audience.

A good analogy is that 'tone' is your mood based on the situation or audience, and 'voice' is your consistent personality.

These elements work together to reflect who 'you' are.

The Nexus TOV should reflect our core values of: Expert, Dependable and Supportive.



Tone



Voice



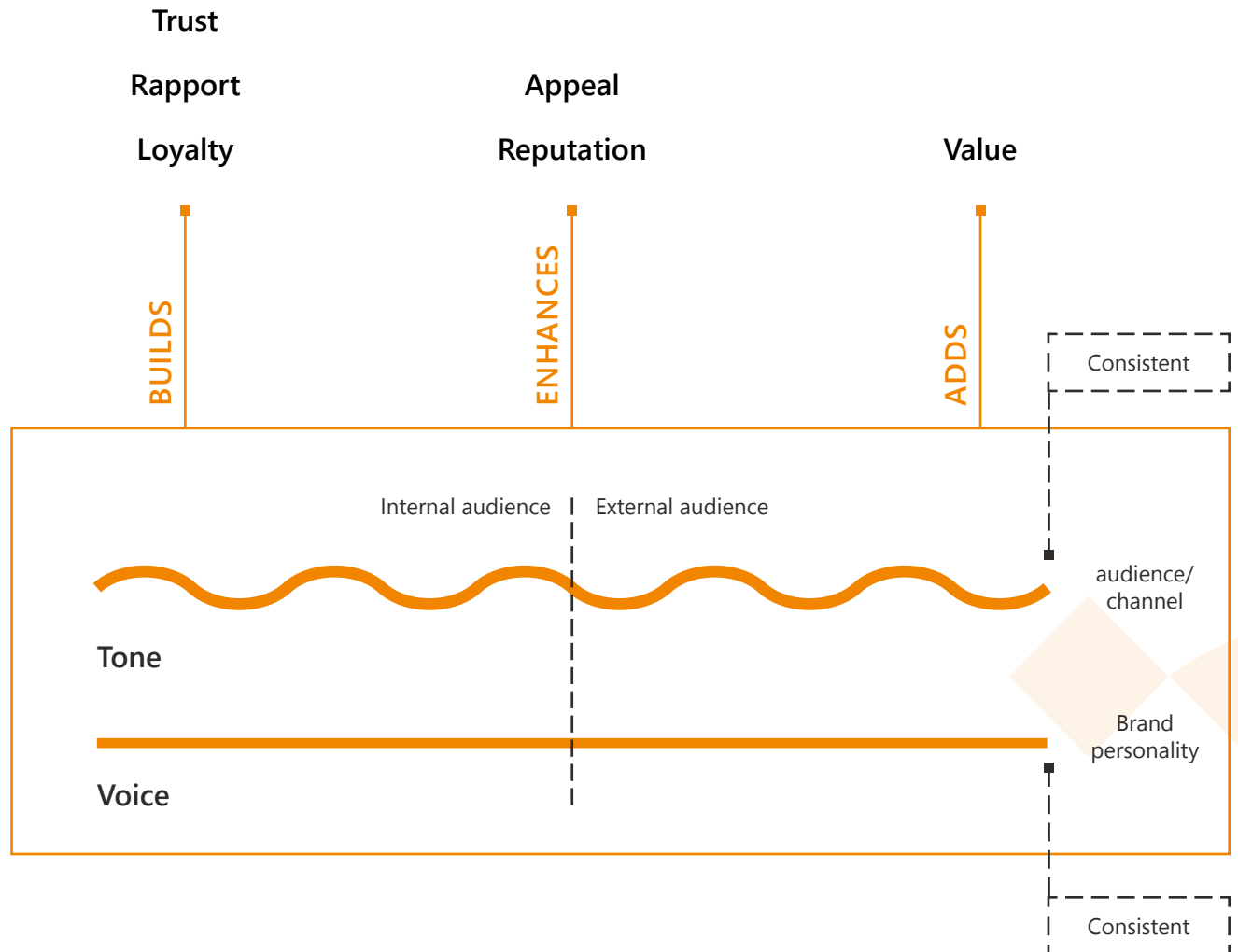
1.2

Tone of voice

Purpose

The best TOVs are trustworthy, authentic and approachable, encouraging customers and potential customers to interact with the brands.

Practice makes perfect - the more you write, the more your brand tone of voice becomes 'you'.



Lean on us to lead the way

Award winning IT services

To help you focus on running your business, we take care of the technology that runs your work day.

Powering productivity

Whether it's day-to-day project management across different locations, or directing plans and strategies at board level, our dedicated team provides the best IT systems, service and support for our clients.

Powering performance

Our proactive approach means it's always business as usual. We apply our specialist understanding of technology to keep your IT system running smoothly and securely, and address any potential challenges before they become a problem. This keeps us all at the top of our game.

Powering potential

We bring the benefits of the latest technological advances directly to our clients. Our accredited portfolio of technical services will continue to provide the IT expertise you need to succeed - today and tomorrow.

1.3

Tone of voice

Master

This paragraph is an example of our master TOV. It highlights that we:

- believe in the real-life benefits of technology, and how this is of value to our clients.
- are professional and approachable, We are here to help, advise and inspire clients with our reputable knowledge of IT.
- do what we say we'll do, building up trustworthy partnerships with our clients.
- work with our clients to offer a helping hand and put a 'human' face to the technology.

2.0

Communication

Summary

These are x4 key ways that we communicate with our clients and our team.





Communication	Description	Application
1. External	1a. 'Standard'. Primary brand tone of voice, appealing to key audience. 1b. 'Formal'. Slightly more authoritative approach for clients that require a more formal tone.	1a. Digital and print, including website, sales proposal, literature, and email campaigns. 1b. Tender documents e.g. public sector
2. Technical	External, internal and one-to-one communications that include technical terms to provide additional guidance or highlight expertise	e.g. blog posts, email and downloadable PDFs.
3. One to one	Written from an individual to an individual	e.g. tickets, and emails.
4. Social	'Human to human' communications for social media	e.g. LinkedIn/Facebook.

2.1

Communication

1. External

- 1a. 'Standard'. Primary brand tone of voice, appealing to key audience.
- 1b. 'Formal'. Slightly more authoritative approach for clients that require a more formal tone.

- 1a. Digital and print, including website, sales proposal, literature, and email campaigns.
- 1b. Tender documents
e.g. public sector

Communication

Description

Application

We want our clients to

Think	Feel
- They know exactly what they're doing - Expert - We can trust them to take care of everything - Dependable - That we're proactive and can help every step of the way - Supportive	- Reassured - Considered - Enlightened

Remember

Do	Don't
Do use emotive headlines in standard communications to resonate with our audience. e.g. "Lean on us to lead the way". This highlights the benefits of what we do (e.g. you can depend on us as we're at the forefront of IT technology) in a way that creates a more 'human' connection. Our audience is more likely to read on as well. Do break up longer communications (e.g. websites, brochures) with sublines that highlight key messages, describing what we do and how it helps with a mix of short and medium-length sentences to make the content more engaging. See example on right > Do use positive language to show our capabilities, and champion the benefits of technology in business, referring back to our values where possible. e.g. "We bring the benefits of the latest technological advances directly to you." = our expert and supportive values in practice. Do address our clients and customers directly as "you" in standard communications to build a more personable rapport. In formal communications, do refer to our clients and customers initially as "clients" (third person), and as "you" (second person) from then on. Do refer to the Nexus team either as "our team is" (i.e. one, united team/collective noun), or as "we/us" (first person) to make it clear that we are the ones conversing with our audience directly - more personable, trustworthy and believable.	Don't focus on the negatives, or exclude certain audiences with technical details from the outset (see: technical communications for further information). Don't overpromise or oversell. e.g. "We guarantee to fix any IT problem within the hour, at any hour." We want our audience to trust us and our work, and so only commit to things that we know we can achieve. Don't complicate language with technical jargon. For our regular communication we should ensure the language is accessible by all audiences. Further technical detail should be included in separate areas. (see: technical communications for further information) Don't exclude information between TOV styles of 1a. and 1b. Both should convey the same message but with a slightly different tone to ensure it meets the requirement of the relevant audience.

Example

"Powering performance /
Subline/Our proactive approach means it's always business as usual. /
Benefit—short sentence/We apply our specialist understanding of technology to keep your IT system running [...] /
Evidence'—medium-length sentence/

1a. 'Standard' communications

Lean on us to lead the way

Award winning IT services

To help you focus on running your business, we take care of the technology that runs your work day.

Powering productivity

Whether it's day-to-day project management across different locations, or directing plans and strategies at board level, our dedicated team provides the best IT systems, service and support for the job.

Powering performance

Our proactive approach means it's always business as usual. We apply our specialist understanding of technology to keep your IT system running smoothly and securely, and address any potential challenges before they become a problem. This keeps us all at the top of our game.

Powering potential

We bring the benefits of the latest technological advances directly to you. Our accredited portfolio of technical services will continue to provide the IT expertise you need to succeed - today and tomorrow.

1b. 'Formal' communications

Leading the way

Award winning IT services

As your trusted IT partner, we take care of the technology that will help advance your business.

Powering productivity

Whether it's managing multiple departments in different locations, or directing plans and strategies at board level, our dedicated team provides the best IT systems, service and support for our clients.

Powering performance

Our proactive approach and specialist understanding of technology keep your IT system running smoothly and securely. We can also address any potential challenges before they become a problem.

Powering potential

We bring the benefits of the latest technology directly to our clients. Our accredited portfolio of technical services will continue to provide the IT expertise you need to succeed - today and tomorrow.

2.1

Communication

In practice

- Emotive headline (in standard communications) to resonate with our clients.
- Lead with the benefit our service/support/expertise brings to the business/our clients.
- Highlight the strength of our team, and that clients can trust us and our work.
- Use subheadings to highlight key messages in a positive/can do way.
- 'Translate' our knowledge of technology to include our clients in the conversation.
- Champion the short- and long-term benefits of technology in business.
- 1b. Highlight the business partnership, and reduce colloquialisms in more formal communications.

2.2

Communication

2. Technical

External, internal and one-to-one communications that include technical terms to provide additional guidance or highlight expertise

e.g. blog posts, email and downloadable PDFs.

Communication

Description

Application

We want our clients to

Think

- They know exactly what they're doing - **Expert**
- We can trust them to take care of everything - **Supportive/Dependable**
- They have the best knowledge of IT - **Expert**

Feel

- Able to trust us
- Enlightened
- Reassured

Remember

Do

- **Do address our clients and customers directly as "you"** in technical communications to build trust and rapport.
- **Do refer to the Nexus team either as "our team is"** (i.e. one, united team/collective noun), **or as "we/us"** (first person) to make it clear that we are the ones conversing with our audience directly - more personable, trustworthy and believable.
- **Do use factual headlines** in technical communications that detail some benefits of the product or service, along **with the name of the product or service as the subline**. This helps the audience relate to/understand the information.
- **Do structure the technical communications to improve reader comprehension.**
 - why do we need this product or service (intro using everyday language from our standard communications)
 - what is the challenge?
 - how does the technology answer this?
 - what are the key benefits?
- **Do act as a 'translator' for our clients**, describing the technology in ways that are relatable/reinforce the benefits of the product or service. e.g. "This is one of the most effective ways to increase data access securely, and maximise your return on investment."
- **Do direct readers to areas where further information** can be accessed e.g. giving access to business contact details or hyperlink to the relevant service page within the website.)

Don't

- **Don't focus on the negatives** - if necessary, 'sandwich' any negatives between two positive pieces of information. e.g. "Updates are a necessary part of IT, keeping everything running smoothly and securely. /positive/ Sometimes, these can cause unexpected delays and disrupt your work. /negative/ Once we get these issues fixed, we'll have everything up and running..." /positive/
- **Don't use technical jargon** without using the structure seen here

Safe, secure & scalable

Data storage

As your organisation grows, you will need more space to store all the data that's integral to your business.

We can provide and manage the most suitable, secure and cost-effective data storage environment to suit your needs.

Data virtualisation

This is one of the most effective ways to increase data access securely, and maximise your return on investment.

It involves consolidating data from multiple physical servers into one virtual machine (VM), all while retaining the ability to function independently.

This means that multiple data sources can be delivered as a single source, in the required format, at the right time, to any application or user.

- Integrate data into a centralised system
- Manage data securely in the office or remotely
- Deliver data to business user in real time

Contact our business development team for further information on our data storage options.)

Virtual machine

A virtual machine (VM) is a virtual environment that functions as a computer system with its own central processing unit, memory, network interface, and storage.

2.2

Communication

In practice

- Factual headline that details some benefits of + the name of the product/service, which is supported by a brief introduction.
- Structure technical communications to improve reader comprehension:
 - What is the challenge?
 - How does the technology answer this?
 - What are the key benefits?
- Act as a 'translator' for our clients, describing the technology in ways that are relatable.

For more information visit:
[hyperlink]

2.3

Communication

3. One to one

Written from an individual to an individual

e.g. tickets, and emails.

Communication

Description

Application

We want our clients to

Think	Feel
• They know exactly what they're doing - Expert • I can trust them with my IT - Dependable • They help me every step of the way - Supportive	• Reassured • In safe hands • Grateful

Remember

Do	Don't
• Do start each email with a "Hi [first name]," and address existing clients directly in the second person to build rapport. i.e. 'you'. • Do use a polite and informal tone to reinforce that we're a professional company, as well as an approachable team. e.g. "Thanks for contacting us at the Nexus service desk." / "One of our engineers will be in contact with you shortly." • Do address the challenge and explain the answer/available options, remaining positive and can-do. e.g. "We understand that your emails aren't leaving the draft folder. To fix this, there are a few options we can try {...}." • Do sign-off correspondence with the name of a team member to make the client feel like they're conversing with a 'real' person. (Although a desk robot is OK for a chase ticket, as the client obviously hasn't replied to the original message) • Do keep communication succinct, with key actions in bold to aid skim reading. • Do use your Nexus signature to sign off emails when responding on behalf of yourself. • Do use punctuation to break up your sentence and ensure you sound professional. Spellchecker can help with this.)	• Don't make the client feel like they shouldn't be contacting you. Try to sympathise with their situation, even if they're becoming impatient. • Don't use technical language, unless backed up with an 'everyday' explanation (see: technical communications for more information). • Don't focus on the negatives - if necessary, 'sandwich' any negatives between two positive pieces of information. (see: technical communications for further information).

Logged calls

Hi [**contact's first name**],

Thanks for contacting the Nexus service desk.

Your support ticket number is [xxx].

To check the status of your ticket, or to provide additional information, please:

1. Send us an email (with the ticket number in the subject line)
2. Log into your **client portal**
3. Call us on **01392 667570** (service desk hours 8am - 6pm Mon-Fri)

If you have a 24/7 support contract, you can also call an engineer at any time on the specialist support desk number.

A Nexus engineer will be in contact with you shortly.

Many thanks,

[name of team member]

[personal Nexus signature]

Chase tickets

Chase ticket 2

Hi [**contact's first name**],

To fix support ticket [number], we still need a bit more information.

You can add a reply to the ticket by:

1. Sending us an email (with the ticket number in the subject line)
2. Logging into your **client portal**
3. Calling us on **01392 667570** (service desk hours 8am - 6pm Mon-Fri)

A ticket summary is shown below.

If this ticket is now resolved, please let us know. We automatically close most tickets if we don't hear back from you after a few days.

Thank you in advance for your assistance,

Nexus Service Desk Robot

2.3

Communication

In practice

Refer to our existing clients by their first name, and address the contact directly to build rapport. i.e. 'you'.

Keep communications as succinct as possible (particularly as most clients will skim-read the messages).

Use a polite and informal tone to reinforce that we're a professional company providing an award-winning service, but we're also an approachable team and want to help.

Sign-off correspondence with the name of a team member to make the client feel like they're conversing with a 'real' person. A desk robot is OK for a chase ticket, as the client obviously hasn't replied to the original message.

2.4

Communication

4. Social

'Human to human'
communications for social media

e.g. LinkedIn/Facebook.

Communication

Description

Application

We want our clients to

Think	Feel
• They know exactly what they're doing - Expert • They look and sound like a great company - Supportive • They're IT experts, but they're also human - Dependable	• Reassured • Inspired • Encouraged

Remember

Do	Don't
• Do highlight the benefits of IT and what we do in a 'fun' and relatable way. e.g. Back it up, back it up. Every 5 mins, in fact. It's part of what we do to keep your technology tip-top all the time. • Do explain the work we do and how we can help. • Do converse with followers to build rapport (both customers and other businesses). e.g. "Great idea, @[name]. We'll add this to our next Microsoft webinar. Hope to see you there!" • Do use active verbs and ask questions to prompt conversation with our clients and peers. e.g. "Discover / use/ try/ what do you think?" • Do promote upcoming events and webinars that showcase our expertise, and invite people along. • Do highlight the strength of our team, and that clients can trust us and our work. e.g. "24/7 support from our wonderful team of IT engineers (we could only fit a few in pic here). Let us know how we can help." • Do send testimonials to other businesses to help them out. • Do use punctuation to break up long sentences. • Do share and interact with Partnered or relevant accounts e.g. share latest posts from VEEAM • Do include an image with each social post • Do use relevant hashtags that relate to the product/service/benefit or the culture at Nexus.	• Don't be negative or publicly voice complaints. E.g. "The latest [xxx] software is rubbish—avoid!" • Don't share/repost information that goes against the company's values. • Don't post content from other sources without crediting the owner. e.g. Inspirational video made by @[name]

Be 'appy

Discover 7 business apps that will make your work day even more productive: [\[link to blog post\]](#)

Back it up, back it up

Every 5 mins, in fact. It's part of what we do to keep your technology tip-top all the time.

Threads, slash commands, and pins. What else is new in Microsoft Teams?

Threads, slash commands, and pins. What else is new in Microsoft Teams?

1 day to go!

Join us tomorrow at 1pm(gmt) as we put all the latest Microsoft Teams' updates into practice: [\[link to sign-up\]](#)

3 technologies that you used to know:

1. Floppy disc
2. Fax machine
3. VHS

What will be on this list in 10 years' time?

[#throwbackThursday](#)

24/7 support from our wonderful team of IT engineers (we could only fit a few in pic here). Let us know how we can help.

Team lunch at our favourite @restaurant.

Great time had by all, as always - thanks Nadia and co.! [\[team photo\]](#)

2.4

Communication

In practice

Use active verbs and ask questions to prompt conversation with our clients and peers.

Promote upcoming events and webinars that showcase our expertise.

Highlight the strength of our team, and that clients can trust us and our work.

Send testimonials to other businesses to help them out.



neXus